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Strategy

Strategic Management Journal

1. Simulating strategic interactions with AI agents

Authors: Matteo Tranchero, Cecil-Francis Brenninkmeijer, Arul Murugan, Abhishek Nagaraj

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70112](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70112)

Published: 2026-07-29

Keywords: AI agents, exploration and exploitation, Large Language Models, strategic interactions, strategy experiments

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Computational Social Science, Artificial Intelligence, Research Methods
- **Theories:** Exploration-Exploitation Dilemma, Agent-Based Modeling, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Simulation Research

Abstract:

Research Summary: We explore how Large Language Models (LLMs) can serve as synthetic subjects to inform strategy research. We introduce a framework for designing and running simulated experiments with LLM-powered agents. We argue that this approach is useful for rapid, low-cost prototyping of human experiments and for generating novel hypotheses. We apply the framework to the exploration–exploitation dilemma and show that LLM-based experiments reproduce patterns observed among human participants. We then vary parameters and boundary conditions to illustrate how the same setup can support design iteration and surface hypotheses about when and why established results change. In the conclusion, we discuss the promise and limitations of artificial intelligence agents as “model organisms” for strategy.

Managerial Summary: Artificial intelligence (AI) agents are beginning to enter firms as tools that can execute work, from writing code to coordinating complex tasks across systems. This article argues that their value for strategy extends beyond task automation: AI agents can also be used to simulate strategic interactions and assess how strategies perform under alternative assumptions. In our exploration–exploitation application, these simulations reproduce core patterns from prior human experiments and reveal where those patterns weaken or reverse. Used this way, AI agents can help firms prototype strategic choices, stress-test assumptions, and direct managerial attention toward promising leads before larger commitments of time and effort.

KEYWORDS AI agents, exploration and exploitation, Large Language Models, strategic interactions, strategy experiments 1 |

□ Tranchero - Simulating strategic interactions with AI agents.pdf

2. Disentangling contract and law: Legal specificity and contractual governance in public–private partnerships

Authors: Mohammad Hosseini, Bertrand V. Quelin

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70111](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70111)

Published: 2026-07-24

Keywords: contractual governance, demand risk, institutional constraints, legal specificity, public–private partnerships

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, International Business, Corporate Governance, Public-Private Partnerships
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Transaction Cost Economics, Contractual Governance, Political Econ-

Abstract:

Research Summary: This study examines how legal design shapes contractual governance in public–private partnership (PPP). We argue that PPP-specific laws do not simply strengthen institutional safeguards; by varying in detail, they also alter the flexibility available for project-level contracting. Highly specific laws better constrain governmental discretion but raise adaptation costs, making user-pay contracts, where private partners bear demand risk and rely on market-responsive adjustment, less attractive. Less specific laws preserve greater contractual discretion and are therefore associated with more user-pay arrangements. We also show that countries with weaker political constraints adopt more specific PPP laws, suggesting that legal design compensates for weaker institutional checks. Using 3986 PPP projects in 53 countries from 1997 to 2021, we find support for these claims. **Managerial Summary:** Governments often pass public–private partnership (PPP) laws to attract private capital into infrastructure projects. This study shows that what matters is not only whether such laws exist, Received: 3 June 2026 Revised: 3 June 2026 Accepted: 13 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70111 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-NoDerivs License, which permits use and distribution in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited, the use is non-commercial and no modifications or adaptations are made. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–31. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 but how detailed they are. Highly specific laws can make government commitments more credible, especially where political checks and balances are weak, but they can also limit the flexibility private partners need when revenues depend on users, such as tolls or fees. Across 3986 PPP projects in 53 countries, we find that more detailed laws are linked to fewer user-pay projects, while less detailed laws are linked to greater use of user-pay arrangements. Our analysis suggests that legal certainty and flexibility must be balanced: specific legal regimes can protect private investment while narrowing the range of viable investment models. **KEYWORDS** contractual governance, demand risk, institutional constraints, legal specificity, public–private partnerships 1 |

□ Hosseini - Disentangling contract and law Legal specificity and contractual governance in p.pdf

3. Revisiting industry effects: The assignment of firms to industries

Authors: Alireza Eshraghi, Bart S. Vanneste

DOI: [10.1002/smj.70106](https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.70106)

Published: 2026-07-15

Keywords: Bayesian hierarchical modeling, embedding model, industry classification, industry effects, variance decomposition

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Industrial Organization, Research Methods, Machine Learning
- **Theories:** Variance Decomposition, Industry Effects, Classification Theory, Firm Effects

Abstract:

Research Summary: Strategy research examines the drivers of firm performance. Variance decomposition studies have analyzed industry's impact, with little attention paid to the industry to which a firm is assigned. This study investigates how industry assignment affects the findings about industry's impact. We analyze existing industry classification schemes and introduce a machine learning-based scheme that leverages an embedding model to process text from annual reports. We find that industry assignment differs substantially across schemes, and that certain firms are more consistently grouped together. Schemes that group more similar firms together exhibit stronger industry effects. Given the literature's frequent reliance on the criticized Standard Industrial Classification scheme, industry's role in firm performance has likely been systematically underestimated. **Managerial Summary:** Understanding what drives a company's success is crucial. Prior research has surprisingly found that a firm's industry plays little role in explaining a firm's performance. However, this study suggests that industry's importance is likely understated due to how firms are grouped into industries. Comparing several existing industry classification schemes Received: 6 March 2024 Revised: 30 March 2026 Accepted: 5 April 2026 DOI: 10.1002/smj.70106 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction

in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Management Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd. Strat Mgmt J. 2026;1–30. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/smj 1 alongside a new one we built using machine learning, we find that grouping similar firms in the same industry increases reported industry importance and decreases firm importance. Being more precise about industry membership reveals that industry matters more than previously thought. The implication is that understanding the industry is more important for a firm's performance and could be key to understanding sustained success. **KEYWORDS** Bayesian hierarchical modeling, embedding model, industry classification, industry effects, variance decomposition 1 |

□ Eshraghi - Revisiting industry effects The assignment of firms to industries.pdf

Administrative Science Quarterly

1. Book Review: Stefan Timmermans and Iddo Tavory. Data Analysis in Qualitative Research: Theorizing with Abductive Analysis

Authors: Siobhan O' MahonyFeld Family Professor of Innovation and Entrepreneurship, Department Chair, Management and Organizations, Boston University, Questrom School of Business, USA

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261468233](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261468233)

Published: 2026-07-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Research Methods, Qualitative Research, Organizational Theory, Sociology of Knowledge
- **Theories:** Abductive Analysis, Grounded Theory, Theorizing, Discovery vs. Validation

Abstract:

A great many texts try to explain how to design and analyze field research projects. But few explain how to do so in ways that produce the unexpected. While some scholars are concerned with replication and the ability to validate prior research, most journals prioritize discovery of novel theoretical advancements. This discovery often comes in the form of surprise: the unexpected or foiling of expectations. As Timmermans and Tavory argue, "If you are unwilling to ask questions that may give you answers you didn't expect . . . you are not doing research" (p.14). The authors offer a fresh perspective on this dimension: How should we design and conduct research if our aim is to discover surprise? If we take discovery and the element of surprise seriously, what should we do differently? Can we actually plan for surprise? I think that Timmermans and Tavory would argue that you can prepare yourself for surprise, as how to do so is the focus of this book. *Data Analysis in Qualitative Research* builds on arguments outlined in the authors' prior book, *Abductive Analysis: Theorizing Qualitative Research* (2014), and is primarily concerned with how to apply abduction throughout the research process. As the authors note in their latest book, its title is a bit misleading, as data analysis is just a small section of the book, which includes chapters on research design, collecting data, coding, writing, and theorizing—all through the lens of abduction. Having taught field methods for several years, I have observed that many students struggle to understand what abduction is and how to apply it. For the authors, abductive analysis is the process of crafting theory: "figuring out both what surprising observations are a theoretical case of, and where the theoretical case and the findings diverge in interesting ways" (p.2). For anyone teaching, conducting, or learning field methods, this book will enrich the toolkit and help to address many questions about abductive analysis. In this review, I focus on some of the book's counterintuitive approaches to producing surprise that diverge from other books on qualitative or grounded theory methods. Timmermans and Tavory offer quality ideas on ways to cultivate surprise, such as seeking variation. Many field researchers focus on demonstrating replication by showing commonalities across units of study. Timmermans and Tavory take a different approach, urging authors to appreciate and to seek variation in their data. They argue that this is essential for generating theory that counters expectations: "You are in a much better position to find surprises if you have..."

□ Entrepreneurship - Book Review Stefan Timmermans and Iddo Tavory. Data Analysis in Qualitative Rese.pdf

2. Book Review: Patrick McGee. Apple in China: The Capture of the World's Greatest Company

Authors: Kunyuan QiaoD' Amore-McKim School of Business, Northeastern University, Boston, MA

DOI: [10.1177/00018392261472813](https://doi.org/10.1177/00018392261472813)

Published: 2026-07-22

Abstract not available. □ Business - Book Review Patrick McGee. Apple in China The Capture of the World's Greatest Co.pdf

Academy of Management Review

1. Toward an Architecture of Visioning: Insights From Gaudí's Sagrada Familia

Authors: Yih-Teen Lee

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2025.0897](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2025.0897)

Published: 2026-07-20

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Leadership, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Process Theory, Generative Organizing Systems, Sociomateriality, Collective Future-making

Abstract:

Vision is widely recognized as a central leadership mechanism for motivating followers and directing collective action. Yet, existing research has largely treated vision as a leader-articulated statement or communicative act, offering limited insight into how visions endure, evolve, and remain collectively enacted over extended periods of time. Drawing on Antoni Gaudí's Sagrada Familia as a theoretical lens, this paper develops a theory of visioning as a generative organizing system of collective future-making. I conceptualize the architecture of visioning as comprising three interdependent processes: vision crafting, through which collective futures are imagined and articulated; vision structuring, through which they are anchored in temporal, symbolic and material arrangements; and vision resonating, through which they become collectively inhabited and carried forward by collaborators. Together, these processes operate recursively through the interplay of leadership and organizing, generating inviting and enabling effects that support the realization of collective futures. By shifting attention from vision statements to visioning systems, this paper reframes vision as an ongoing organizing accomplishment and offers a new perspective on how collective futures are created and sustained across generations.

□ Lee - Toward an Architecture of Visioning Insights From Gaudí's Sagrada Familia.pdf

2. The Generative AI Dilemma in Knowledge-Intensive Teams

Authors: Jessica A. Reif, Jonathon N. Cummings

DOI: [10.5465/amr.2024.0538](https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2024.0538)

Published: 2026-07-17

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Team Dynamics, Information Systems
- **Theories:** Network Theory, Multilevel Theory, Substitution Logic, Social Exchange Theory

Abstract:

In knowledge-intensive teams, collaborative interactions among teammates have historically served as the primary means through which members access task-relevant information, advice, and feedback. Generative artificial intelligence (AI), however, now offers members an alternative source of these resources. We develop a multilevel theory that proposes team members who are proficient with generative AI are more likely to perceive the resources it can offer as functionally equivalent to those they can access through their teammates. In turn, we propose that some members will shift their knowledge-seeking interactions to generative AI. As this substitution behavior accumulates within a team, the team's collaboration network is less likely to fos-

ter the critical emergent states that support team effectiveness. The key insight of our theory is a dilemma for knowledge-intensive teams: generative AI can boost team performance by helping members to work more efficiently, but a lack of collaboration among teammates can offset these gains and undermine team satisfaction.

□ Reif - The Generative AI Dilemma in Knowledge-Intensive Teams.pdf

Organization Science

1. Exploring Leaders' Mindfulness in Navigating Organizational Paradox

Authors: Gail T. Fairhurst, Sophia Town, Sarah J. Tracy

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.19430](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.19430)

Published: 2026-07-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Leadership, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Paradox Theory, Sensemaking, Metacognition, Dual-process Theory

Abstract:

This study focuses on the role of mindfulness in organizational leaders' responses to paradoxical tensions. We arrive at this focus by interpreting the organizational paradox literature as suggesting two primary ways that leaders mindfully engage paradoxical tensions, which work in tandem. There is an absorbed mode implied in embracing tensions and finding energy in them and a more deliberative mode in weighing tensional poles to formulate more adaptive responses. A view of mindfulness as a metacognitive practice skill fully captures both absorbed and deliberative aspects, offering a way to understand the role of mindfulness in responding to paradoxical tensions. In this qualitative study, we explore how leaders with and without a regular mindfulness practice deploy these dual approaches in their sensemaking accounts of paradoxical tensions. Findings suggest that leaders who do not practice mindfulness relied heavily on deliberative engagement and pivoted less often between absorbed and deliberative modes. Leaders who practice mindfulness focused on absorbed engagement and pivoted more often between modes. Our analysis suggests that absorbed and deliberative practices together provide mindfulness-trained leaders with just enough structure to cope with paradoxical tensions by turning them into focused learners with flexible processing, expanded repertoires, and holistic engagement.

□ Fairhurst - Exploring Leaders' Mindfulness in Navigating Organizational Paradox.pdf

2. Bottoms Up: Microentry Nonmarket Strategies to Change State Policy

Authors: Eppa Rixey

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.18500](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18500)

Published: 2026-07-22

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Venue Shifting, Punctuated Equilibrium, Microentry Strategy

Abstract:

How do small firms overcome regulatory constraints despite opposition from entrenched interests? Microentry strategies enable small firms to compete with larger incumbents in markets, but exploration of such strategies in nonmarket arenas is limited. Existing research suggests that, when firms face regulatory constraints, they often venue shift upward, for example, overturning a local ban by lobbying for statewide legislation. This article uses qualitative data on craft breweries to identify and analyze a set of microentry nonmarket strategies through which firms engage locally, venue shifting downward from state to local regulators, to successfully ease state-level constraints from the bottom up. In public hearings with city officials, entrepreneurs aligned local investment tactics and supportive coalitions with an iterative approach

that motivated city-based regulators to challenge state-level restrictions on direct-to-consumer (DTC) business models that are favorable to smaller firms. Experimenting locally with the discretionary use of “event” licenses for ongoing DTC beer sales led to an accumulation of bottom-up support across locales. This support included relational infrastructure and policy-relevant information that enabled entrepreneurs to work through city officials to overcome incumbent opposition. By elaborating how small firms and local officials together create punctuations in a state-level policy monopoly and analyzing both the antecedents and consequences, this study builds a theory of microentry nonmarket strategy and bottom-up policy change. Even in a mature industry with well-institutionalized regulations, powerful incumbents opposing changes, and minimal technological change, small businesses reshaped the policy environment of an entire state from the bottom up. Funding: This work was supported by the Sloan School of Management, Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

□ Rixey - Bottoms Up Microentry Nonmarket Strategies to Change State Policy.pdf

3. From Founders’ Knowledge to Economic Value Capture in Academic and Employee Start-ups

Authors: Mahka Moeen

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2023.18121](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.18121)

Published: 2026-07-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Knowledge-Based View, Human Capital Theory, Markets for Technology, Value Capture Framework

Abstract:

Economic value capture is crucial for entrepreneurial start-ups as it conditions the commercial viability of the technological opportunities underlying their founding. Start-ups vary in whether they capture value and, if so, whether through markets for product or technology. This study posits that value capture hinges on founders’ knowledge accumulated in their prior employment context, separating founders as academic scientists and former employees of industry firms. Academic founders bring scientific knowledge from universities, and within-industry employee founders carry industry-specific knowledge from their former employer. These differences provide the theoretical basis that the study empirically explores in U.S. medical device start-ups. Academic start-ups tend to capture value in markets for technology, whereas within-industry employee start-ups tend to capture value in markets for product. Further, variations in founders’ history and employment context can bridge scientific and commercial dimensions in knowledge profiles within academic and employee start-ups, shifting the resulting value capture pathway toward pioneering products. Funding: This work was supported by the Richard M. Schulze Family Foundation and the Ewing Marion Kauffman Foundation. Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2023.18121>.

□ Moeen - From Founders’ Knowledge to Economic Value Capture in Academic and Employee Start.pdf

4. The Durability of Compliance Under External Accountability: The Case of the Police Data Initiative

Authors: Tae-Ung Choi, Minjae Kim

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2024.18975](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18975)

Published: 2026-07-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Public Management, Strategic Management
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, External Accountability, Organizational Compliance

Abstract:

External accountability initiatives, which combine public disclosure of internal information with enforcement, are widely regarded as useful instruments to effect organizational compliance with external demands. Yet, even though such compliance may be fruitful only if it persists, its durability has been assumed rather than directly tested. We report on such direct tests, using the Police Data Initiative (PDI). Launched across the United States in 2015 to “decrease inappropriate uses of force,” especially against Black citizens, the PDI mandated the release of traffic stop data and increased oversight of participating local police departments. A difference-in-differences analysis across 36 police departments shows that PDI adoption initially reduced stops, especially in neighborhoods with more Black residents. Over time, however, these treated departments reversed course and ultimately increased stops, particularly in said neighborhoods. This backsliding was more pronounced in departments with higher pre-PDI stop rates and larger racial disparities. Our findings show limited durability of compliance under external accountability and identify conditions under which external accountability reinforces entrenched patterns over time. Open Access Statement: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License. You are free to copy, distribute, transmit and adapt this work, but you must attribute this work as “Organization Science. Copyright © 2026 The Author(s). <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18975>, used under a Creative Commons Attribution License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>.” Supplemental Material: The online appendix is available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2024.18975>.

□ Choi - The Durability of Compliance Under External Accountability The Case of the Polic.pdf

Academy of Management Journal

1. Ideology or Identity? CEO Political Party Affiliation and Conformity in Competitive Strategy

Authors: Krishnan Nair, Eric Lee

DOI: [10.5465/amj.2024.0596](https://doi.org/10.5465/amj.2024.0596)

Published: 2026-07-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Upper Echelons, Political Psychology
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Social Identity Theory, Self-Concordance Theory

Abstract:

Building on the premise that political party affiliation reflects one’s ideology and core values, various studies in the upper echelons literature have examined the link between CEO political party affiliation and decision-making. In contrast, recent work in political psychology suggests that party affiliation shapes behavior largely because it serves as a salient social identity. Taking a reconciliatory approach, the present work highlights the value of both perspectives in explaining the CEO’s orientation toward conformity. According to the ideology literature, Republicans display greater conformity than Democrats due to dispositional differences in how much they value conformity. On the other hand, the identity perspective suggests that both Democrats and Republicans strive to conform to co-partisans and distinguish themselves from counter-partisans. Integrating insights from both perspectives, we theorize that Republican CEOs generally display greater conformity than Democratic CEOs due to dispositional differences, but that the extent to which these dispositional tendencies translate to competitive strategy depends on the political composition of CEOs in a given industry. Finally, we draw on self-concordance theory to theorize about the performance implications of fit and misfit between CEO party affiliation and conformity. We find support for our predictions in a sample of S&P 500 firms from 2010 to 2019.

□ Nair - Ideology or Identity CEO Political Party Affiliation and Conformity in Competiti.

Innovation & Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. The Paradox of Inclusion: Modeling Systemic Dynamics of the Gender Finance Gap in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems

Authors: Nicolás Fuentes, Jana Schmutzler, Gustavo Carreón-Vázquez

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261462834](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261462834)

Published: 2026-07-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Entrepreneurial Financing, Entrepreneurial Ecosystems, Gender Studies
- **Theories:** Complex Adaptive Systems, Agent-Based Modeling, Network Theory, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

Gender inequality in venture capital remains a persistent systemic issue shaped by interacting socio-institutional, network, and entrepreneurial ecosystem (EE) dynamics. This study examines how targeted inclusion interventions interact with structural and network-level dynamics to shape the gender finance gap. Conceptualizing the financial support network (FSN) as a complex adaptive system embedded in an EE, we use agent-based modeling (ABM) to simulate how male-, female-, and mixed-team-founded startups, accelerators, and venture capitalists co-evolve across different levels of ecosystem development and connection regimes. The model examines interventions across three nodes of the financing pipeline: expanding female- and mixed-founded startups at ecosystem entry, implementing positive gender discrimination in accelerator selection, and adopting gender-preferential funds allocation by venture capitalists. We assess how these interventions influence systemic patterns of equity and efficiency under different EE conditions. Results reveal non-linear, context-dependent, and outcome-dependent dynamics. Specifically, in underdeveloped ecosystems, isolated interventions aimed at increasing representation at entry or within accelerators reduce overall investment volume and may temporarily widen the funding gap. By contrast, developed ecosystems absorb such increased representation without major efficiency losses, although representation gains alone do not necessarily translate into more equitable funding outcomes. Conversely, coordinated interventions across multiple stages of the financing pipeline, particularly those combining network access and preferential capital allocation, generate stronger equity gains while maintaining systemic efficiency as ecosystems mature. Overall, these findings conceptualize the gender finance gap as a wicked problem embedded in the adaptive structure of entrepreneurial finance and highlight the importance for systemic, sequenced, and context-sensitive inclusion strategies. 1Universidad del Norte, Barranquilla, Colombia 2Bergische Universität Wuppertal, Germany 3Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México, México Corresponding Author: Nicolás Fuentes, Department of Economics, Universidad del Norte, Km. 5 vía Puerto Colombia, Barranquilla 081007, Atlantico, Colombia. Email: jnfuentes@uninorte.edu.co

□ Fuentes - The Paradox of Inclusion Modeling Systemic Dynamics of the Gender Finance Gap in.pdf

2. Do Family Firms Care about Green Innovation? Competing Socioemotional Wealth Logics and Local Government Influence

Authors: Wen Helena Li, Francesco Chirico, Robert E. Hoskisson

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261462851](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261462851)

Published: 2026-07-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Family Business, Innovation Management, Corporate Environmental Responsibility
- **Theories:** Socioemotional Wealth Perspective, Institutional Contingency Perspective, Stewardship Theory, Conservatism Logic

Abstract:

The evidence is mixed regarding family firms focus on green innovation. Using the socioemotional wealth perspective, we argue that family control have two competing logics, stewardship and conservatism, leading to divergent green innovation outcomes. Integrating an institutional contingency perspective, we show that local government environmental attention shapes which logic prevails. Using listed Chinese family firm

data, we find that high (low) local environmental attention strengthens (weakens) the relationship between family control and green innovation, particularly when firms are geographically closer to local governments. Interestingly, highly controlled family firms are least environmentally responsive when close to governments with low environmental attention.

□ Li - Do Family Firms Care about Green Innovation Competing Socioemotional Wealth
Logi.pdf

3. Guanxi Institution and Entrepreneurship in China: A Societal-Level Analysis With Evidence From Regional Panel Data (1998–2010)

Authors: Wubiao Zhou, Susan Schwarz

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261470047](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261470047)

Published: 2026-07-29

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, International Business, Institutional Economics, Regional Development
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Informal Institutions, Substitution and Competition Effects, Guanxi as an Institution

Abstract:

Despite extensive existing research at the individual/organizational level, it is unclear whether guanxi—predominantly conceptualized at the micro level—supports or constrains entrepreneurship at the societal level. Drawing on institutional theory and the recent guanxi literature conceptualizing guanxi as an informal institution, this study examines the effect of guanxi on entrepreneurship at the societal level by arguing that guanxi as an informal institution can both substitute for and compete with formal institutions. Specifically, we argue that guanxi institution facilitates societal-level entrepreneurship up to a point due to its stronger substitution effect for formal institutions than the competing effect. However, beyond that threshold point, guanxi reduces entrepreneurship stocks because the competing effect with formal institutions is stronger than the substitution effect. We also argue that development of formal institutions can attenuate the main inverted-U-shaped effect of guanxi institution on societal-level entrepreneurship. Fixed effects results with provincial-level panel data from China provide strong support for the hypotheses. This study contributes to the literatures on guanxi and on the role of informal institutions in entrepreneurship.

□ Zhou - Guanxi Institution and Entrepreneurship in China A Societal-Level Analysis
With.pdf

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Unleashing the value of a “scientific approach” to entrepreneurship: Building an empirical research agenda

Authors: Arnaldo Camuffo, Alfonso Gambardella, Thomaz Teodorovicz

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70038](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70038)

Published: 2026-07-24

Keywords: decision making, entrepreneurial education, entrepreneurial learning, scientific method, uncertainty

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Managerial Cognition, Research Methodology
- **Theories:** Entrepreneurs-as-Scientists Perspective, Bayesian Learning, Scientific Method in Management, Boundary Conditions

Abstract:

Research Summary: In this manuscript, we argue that the Entrepreneurs-as-Scientists (E-a-S) research program requires a fundamental shift from predominantly conceptual development toward an empirical agenda

to achieve its normative goal: developing a scalable algorithm that improves entrepreneurial learning and value creation. The E-a-S approach prescribes that entrepreneurs learn by articulating causal theories, testing them, updating their beliefs, and revising their theories. We identify three risks of continued emphasis on conceptual development: overlooked complementarities, insufficient attention to boundary conditions, and potential overprescription based on limited evidence. We propose an empirical research agenda, as well as specific topics within it, to ground the E-a-S approach in systematic evidence, advancing a research program that is as rigorous in its methods as the entrepreneurial practices it seeks to improve. This paper is part of a project that has received funding from the European Research Council (ERC) under the European Union Horizon 2020 research and innovation program (Grant agreement No. 101021061, project SAIM). Received: 8 April 2026 Revised: 24 June 2026 Accepted: 7 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70038 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–20. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 Managerial Summary: This manuscript examines a growing approach that encourages entrepreneurs to think and act like scientists—by clearly articulating assumptions, testing them through experiments, updating beliefs, and refining their strategies. The goal is to develop a reliable, scalable method that improves how entrepreneurs learn and create value. However, current insights and ongoing research projects predominantly focus on conceptual work. We highlight three practical risks of such a focus: missing complementarities, overlooking when the learning method works best, and applying it too broadly without sufficient validation. We suggest that entrepreneurs use this approach flexibly since it was not designed to be a fixed formula. Ongoing research will clarify how to adapt it across contexts, helping entrepreneurs make more informed, disciplined, and effective strategic decisions. KEYWORDS decision making, entrepreneurial education, entrepreneurial learning, scientific method, uncertainty 1 |

□ Camuffo - Unleashing the value of a “scientific approach” to entrepreneurship Building an.pdf

2. Experimentation on a leash: How stakeholder influence shapes entrepreneurial experimentation across the venture lifecycle

Authors: Hyeonsuh Lee, Gianluigi Viscusi, Christopher L. Tucci

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70039](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70039)

Published: 2026-07-20

Keywords: entrepreneurship, experimentation, innovation, stakeholder, venture lifecycle

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Stakeholder Management, Venture Development
- **Theories:** Stakeholder Theory, Resource Dependence Theory, Lean Startup Methodology, Governance Mechanisms

Abstract:

Research Summary: Prior studies have often conceptualized entrepreneurial experimentation as an activity over which founders exert a high amount of discretion in decision-making. However, the locus of control over experimentation programs is dynamic, shifting with varying external stakeholder influence and venture growth. This paper proposes an integrative framework explaining how different stakeholder influence mechanisms function as frictions or enablers, shaping a venture’s experimentation program. Resource provision mechanisms determine ventures’ capacity for experimentation, while stakeholder strategic orientation and governance mechanisms shape the context within which ventures experiment, influencing how ventures deploy resources toward experiments. We further discuss how a venture’s development stage shapes the relative value and impact of these stakeholder influences. Managerial Summary: Experimentation and the Lean Startup approach are well-established methods for Received: 31 December 2024 Revised: 26 June 2026 Accepted: 7 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70039 This is an open access article under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, which permits use, distribution and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. © 2026 The Author(s). Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal published by John Wiley & Sons Ltd on behalf of Strategic Management Society. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–27. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 navigating the inherent uncertainties of entrepreneurial ventures. While conventional wisdom often portrays founders as exercising substantial discretion over experimenta-

tion, this research demonstrates that a venture's experimentation program can be systematically shaped by external stakeholders. Rather than being solely founder- driven, entrepreneurial experimentation is embedded in a broader stakeholder context that conditions what can be tested, how broadly, and how radically. Stakeholders shape ventures' experimentation by providing and controlling resources, influencing strategic directions, and structuring governance relationships. Strategic attention to which actors influence experimentation, how that influence is exercised, and how its relative importance shifts across venture development stages is important for fostering experimentation and improving venture performance. K E Y W O R D S entrepreneurship, experimentation, innovation, stakeholder, venture lifecycle 1 |

□ Lee - Experimentation on a leash How stakeholder influence shapes entrepreneurial expe.pdf

3. Ignited or depressed? Entrepreneurs' status inconsistency and philanthropic giving

Authors: Jianhua Ge, Eric Yanfei Zhao, Wei Lei

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70040](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70040)

Published: 2026-07-19

Keywords: entrepreneurship, philanthropy, relative deprivation, social class, status inconsistency

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Corporate Social Responsibility, Philanthropy, Social Psychology
- **Theories:** Status Inconsistency Theory, Social Identity Theory, Compensation vs. Resentment Mechanisms, Social Stratification

Abstract:

Research Summary: Research has long emphasized entrepreneurs' status as a driver of philanthropy. Extending this literature, we examine how status inconsistency—misalignment among perceived economic, social, and political status—is associated with entrepreneurs' philanthropic contributions. We develop two theoretically grounded but competing interpretations: compensation, which suggests that entrepreneurs may increase giving to offset perceived status imbalance, and resentment, which suggests that perceived imbalance may dampen prosocial engagement. Using a national survey of Chinese private entrepreneurs supplemented with qualitative interviews, we find that while higher perceived status in individual dimensions is positively associated with philanthropy, inconsistency across these status dimensions is, on average, negatively associated with it. Moreover, entrepreneurs from farmer backgrounds, compared with those from upper-class origins, exhibit patterns consistent with stronger compensatory giving. These findings underscore the nuanced implications of multi-dimensional perceived status for entrepreneurial philanthropy. Received: 10 March 2026 Revised: 2 July 2026 Accepted: 10 July 2026 DOI: 10.1002/sej.70040 © 2026 Strategic Management Society. All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies. Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal. 2026;1–26. wileyonlinelibrary.com/journal/sej 1 Managerial Summary: Entrepreneurs' philanthropic behavior depends not only on how high their perceived status is but also on how consistent it is across different domains. When entrepreneurs experience status inconsistency—for example, being economically successful but perceiving weaker social or political standing—this imbalance may be associated with either efforts to compensate through giving or feelings of resentment that suppress it. Overall, entrepreneurs with unbalanced perceived status tend to give less, yet those from lower-class backgrounds are more inclined to donate in ways consistent with status-balancing motives. Our study highlights how the interplay of economic, social, and political status perceptions relates to entrepreneurial philanthropy. K E Y W O R D S entrepreneurship, philanthropy, relative deprivation, social class, status inconsistency 1 |

□ Ge - Ignited or depressed Entrepreneurs' status inconsistency and philanthropic givin.pdf

General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Bifurcation Bias in Executive Compensation and Family Firm Performance: The Role of Normative Context

Authors: Weiwen Li, Xiaotong Li, James J. Chrisman, Hanqing “Chevy” Fang

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70144](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70144)

Published: 2026-07-24

Keywords: bifurcation bias, entitlement, family involvement in management, industry competition, traditional values

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Family Business, Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Justice Theory, Entitlement Theory, Social Embeddedness

Abstract:

Abstract Bifurcation bias, the preferential treatment in favour of family managers over non-family managers, is prevalent in family firms, yet research on its performance implications remains inconclusive. We argue that this inconclusiveness reflects insufficient attention to the normative contexts that shape how non-family managers interpret differential treatment. Drawing on justice and entitlement theories, we argue that non-family managers’ fairness judgments hinge on whether family membership is perceived as a legitimate basis for entitlement. Using longitudinal data on publicly listed Chinese family firms, we find that bifurcation bias in cash-based compensation undermines performance, but that this relationship is contingent on normative context. Specifically, the negative effect is attenuated in regions with stronger traditional values and in firms with greater family involvement in management, whereas it is amplified in highly competitive industries. By demonstrating that entitlement judgments are socially embedded, this study offers a contingency-based resolution to the debate over whether bifurcation bias harms family firm performance and provides practical guidance for family firms seeking to balance fairness with family-centred goals.

□ Li - Bifurcation Bias in Executive Compensation and Family Firm Performance The Role.pdf

2. Beyond Quality and Quantity: Enriching the Study of Organizational Attention

Authors: Davide Nicolini, Matthew Hurst, Jeanne Mengis, Manuel Baeriswyl

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70141](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70141)

Published: 2026-07-21

Keywords: attention, attention based view of the firm, attention theory, Carnegie School, practice theory, situated attention

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Attention-Based View
- **Theories:** Attention-Based View, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Dialectical Perspective

Abstract:

Abstract

This Counterpoint advances the study of organizational attention by proposing an ‘expansive’ rather than a ‘substitutive’ development of the attention-based view (ABV) as proposed in the Point . While endorsing a richer understanding of attention, we caution against reinforcing unhelpful dichotomies between quality and quantity of attention. We argue that the ABV’s perceived limitations, especially its treatment of attention as scarce and quantifiable, reflect Simon’s legacy more than flaws in the ABV itself. We propose three directions for future research: rethinking resource allocation as emerging from competition among attentional sources; developing a thicker view of situatedness in which social dynamics shape attention beyond intentionality; and revisiting scarcity by examining why attention is limited, what kind of scarcity is involved, and when abundance rather than scarcity becomes problematic. By articulating a dialectical position that transcends the thesis of a complete turn to the quality of attending, as in the Point and the antithesis in Counterpoint 2 –stick to quantity and persevere in normal science, we offer a way forward that preserves the strengths of

attentional research while enabling a more nuanced account of organizational attention.

□ Nicolini - Beyond Quality and Quantity Enriching the Study of Organizational Attention.pdf

3. Attention Is Attention: Preserving Ontological Integrity in Organizational Research

Authors: Luke Rhee

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70140](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70140)

Published: 2026-07-19

Keywords: attention, ontology, scarcity, selectivity, situatedness

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Attention-Based View
- **Theories:** Attention-Based View, Ontological Realism, Behavioral Theory of the Firm

Abstract:

Abstract

Inspired by the Attention-Based View of the firm, organizational research has illuminated how organizations learn, adapt, and perform, yet recent theorizing risks diluting attention's explanatory force by compromising its ontological integrity. In this Counterpoint, I argue that attention must be preserved as a scarce, selective, and situated mechanism linking cognition, structure, and behaviour. I clarify the ontological attributes that follow from the definition of attention and show how efforts to re-ontologize attention as 'crescive' risk collapsing causal explanation into phenomenological description. I then argue that many persistent gaps in the literature are misdiagnosed as limitations of the Attention-Based View when they in fact stem from the field's failure to fully exploit the ontology inherent in attention's definition. I develop this claim through two such gaps, limited normative theorizing and insufficient theorization of situations, and advance three research agendas: developing attention patterns that manage scarcity, revealing the costs of selective attention, and designing information environments that condition returns on attention. By preserving rather than dissolving its ontological core, this Counterpoint shows that attention's enduring power lies not in expanding its boundaries but in fully exploiting the scarcity, selectivity, and situatedness it already affords.

□ Rhee - Attention Is Attention Preserving Ontological Integrity in Organizational Resear.pdf

4. Quality over Quantity of Attention! Towards a Qualitative Attention-Based View

Authors: David Seidl, Violetta Splitter, Richard Whittington

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70143](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70143)

Published: 2026-07-16

Keywords: attending, attention quality, attention quantity, practice theory, qualitative Attention-Based View

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Strategy-as-Practice
- **Theories:** Attention-Based View, Practice Theory, Sociomateriality

Abstract:

Abstract

This Point proposes an ontological reorientation of the Attention-Based View from a focus on attention quantity to attention quality –that is, from a quantitative to a qualitative Attention-Based View. This shift is motivated by developments in both academic research and contemporary management. Drawing on practice theory, we reconceptualize attention not as a resource to be allocated and rationed, but as a set of socio-material practices of attending. We identify five constitutive qualities of these attentional practices: sociality, discourse, embodiment, materiality, and historicity. This conceptual shift moves beyond viewing attention

as a limited and homogeneous resource, instead framing attending as a crecive and differentiated set of practices. We argue that this qualitative Attention-Based View offers a deeper understanding of attention, one particularly relevant to contemporary strategizing and organizing.

□ Seidl - Quality over Quantity of Attention! Towards a Qualitative Attention-Based View.pdf

5. Beyond Resilience: The Privilege of Composure Under Geopolitical Tension

Authors: Omid Aliasghar

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70135](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70135)

Published: 2026-07-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** International Business, Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy
- **Theories:** Resilience Theory, Geopolitical Risk, Institutional Theory

Abstract:

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□ Aliasghar - Beyond Resilience The Privilege of Composure Under Geopolitical Tension.pdf

Journal of Management

1. Digital Institutions and Occupational Fraud

Authors: Tingting (Rachel) Chung, Pratyush Nidhi Sharma, Chih-Chen Lee, Weilei (Stone) Shi, Mike W. Peng, Paul Pavlou

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261461518](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261461518)

Published: 2026-07-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** International Business, Strategic Management, Corporate Governance, Digital Economy
- **Theories:** Institution-based View, Deterrence Theory, Internal Control Mechanisms

Abstract:

How do a country's digital institutions influence the magnitude of occupational fraud within firms? Leveraging and extending the institution-based view, we address this understudied question by conceptualizing digital institutions as a new genre of institutions that condition the deterrence calculus within firms. We define digital institutions as the foundational structures and resources that shape a country's digital environment along three key dimensions: (1) digital infrastructure, (2) digital governance, and (3) digital innovation. While strengthening digital institutions has become a priority for policymakers worldwide, the unintended consequences of doing so, such as the potential to facilitate occupational fraud within firms, remain insufficiently understood. Using a unique dataset of 3,974 cases from 41 countries, we find that digital infrastructure is linked to higher fraud magnitude in firms, whereas digital governance is associated with lower occupational fraud magnitude. Our analysis further uncovers the nuanced ways in which digital institutions condition the effectiveness of firm-level internal controls. Overall, Acknowledgments: We thank Senior Editor Peggy Lee and the reviewers for their valuable guidance. This research has been supported by the ACFE Research Institute (ARI) and the Jindal Chair at UT Dallas. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Weilei (Stone) Shi, Associate Professor, Chinese University of Hong Kong, 8/F, Cheng Yu Tung Building, 12 Chak Cheung Street, Shatin, Hong Kong.

□ Chung - Digital Institutions and Occupational Fraud.pdf

2. Make the Alliance Personal: A Dependence Framework of Managerial Personal Tie Activation in Alliance Management

Authors: Han Jiang, Xuan Sun, Yi Peng

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261463168](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261463168)

Published: 2026-07-23

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Strategic Alliances, Inter-organizational Relations
- **Theories:** Resource Dependence Theory, Social Network Theory, Personal Tie Activation

Abstract:

In this study, we explore an intriguing yet understudied question: Would top managers decide to activate personal ties to manage their firms' alliances? We address this question by synthesizing the insights of the research on personal tie activation and resource dependence theory to develop a nuanced theoretical framework on the mechanisms underlying top managers' personal tie activation decisions in alliance management. We highlight that the interdependence features between two alliance partner firms (i.e., mutual dependence, power imbalance, inter partner competition, and the interactions thereof) together shape the partner firms' relational dynamics in the value creation and value appropriation in their alliance. Accordingly, these features determine the potential benefits and costs for top managers of the partner firms to activate their personal ties to manage this alliance, both for their firms and for themselves. We draw empirical evidence from a field study with 244 alliances between Chinese firms and an experimental vignette study with 212 real-world managers in China. Results of our analyses support our predictions, with a few intriguing exceptions. We derive valuable implications for theory and practice.

□ Jiang - Make the Alliance Personal A Dependence Framework of Managerial Personal Tie Act.pdf

3. The Anatomy of Earnings Conference Calls: An Integrative Framework for Management Research

Authors: Matthew P. Mount, Gokhan Ertug, Wei Shi, Tengjian Zou

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261464503](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261464503)

Published: 2026-07-21

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Communications, Management Research Methods
- **Theories:** Communicative Disclosure, Performative Communication, Communicative Trace

Abstract:

The use of earnings conference calls in management research has exploded over recent years, yet insights remain fragmented due to differing assumptions about how calls should be analyzed and interpreted. To synthesize this work, we review 207 articles across management, accounting, and finance journals and map how prior studies have drawn on specific call components—structural attributes, prepared remarks, and question-and-answer exchanges. Building on this anatomical mapping, we inductively identify three epistemic roles through which earnings calls have been mobilized in management research: communicative disclosure (“window”), performative communication (“stage”), and communicative trace (“fingerprint”). Each role reflects distinct assumptions about how earnings calls reveal, enact, or encode managerial and organizational phenomena, and each highlights different opportunities for future theorizing. By making these inferential logics explicit, our framework provides a conceptual foundation for more precise and cumulative use of earnings conference calls as a data source in management scholarship and outlines promising areas for future research.

□ Mount - The Anatomy of Earnings Conference Calls An Integrative Framework for Management

4. The Impact of Strategic Leaders' International Experience on Organizations: An Integrative Review and Multilevel Framework

Authors: Fei Qin, Klaus E. Meyer, Sabina Tasheva Nielsen

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261465642](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261465642)

Published: 2026-07-27

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Leadership, International Business, Upper Echelons Research
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Human Capital Theory, Social Capital Theory, Cognitive Schemas

Abstract:

Internationally experienced business leaders bring distinct human capital, social capital, and cognitive schemas into organizations, influence strategic orientation through their decision-making, and in turn shape organizations' strategies and performance. The impact of the international experience (IE) of an organization's upper echelon has been studied in various bodies of management literature, varying in terms of the theoretical perspectives, conceptualizations of the IE construct, and outcomes considered. However, the effects are not straightforward with regard to which elements of IE affect which aspects of organizational dynamics, and how. This review integrates separate streams of organizational research to develop a more holistic understanding of the role of the IE held by strategic leaders such as chief executive officers, entrepreneurial founders, top management teams, and boards of directors, and its impact on organizational strategies and performance. We refine the conceptualization of the IE construct at multiple levels of analysis and explore cross-level mechanisms suggested by multiple theories to develop an integrative framework that links strategic leaders' IE to organizational decisions, strategies, and performance. On this basis, we propose an agenda for future research.

□ Qin - The Impact of Strategic Leaders' International Experience on Organizations An In.pdf

5. Making Words Count: Computational Linguistics in Management Research

Authors: Joseph J. Simpson, Richard A. Hunt, David M. Townsend, Judy Rady, Elham Asgari, Mohammad Rady, Daniel J. Beal

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261465289](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261465289)

Published: 2026-07-24

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Management Research Methods, Organizational Theory, Computational Social Science
- **Theories:** Computational Linguistics, Construct-Language Fit, Large Language Models

Abstract:

In recent years, a rapidly growing number of management scholars are using computational linguistics (CL) to analyze vast corpora of naturally occurring organizational language. Yet the rapid adoption of CL methods has outpaced the development of shared standards for linking theoretical constructs, linguistic data, and computational measurement. We synthesize 353 articles published in leading management journals for 2013–2025, identifying four recurring challenges shaping the credibility of CL-based research: misalignment between constructs and textual corpora, unnecessary model complexity, the opacity of large language model workflows, and insufficient transparency in reporting. Building on these patterns, we develop four integrative design principles—construct-language fit, minimal sufficient complexity, LLM sensitivity and auditability, and disclosure-as-assessability—and identify key research implications that reposition CL as a theoretically consequential lens for management scholarship. Current affiliation: Judy Rady is now affiliated to Syracuse University. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Joseph J. Simpson, The University of Texas Rio Grande Valley, 402 N Sugar Rd, Edinburg,

□ Simpson - Making Words Count Computational Linguistics in Management Research.pdf

1. Ecosystem Orchestration: Mechanisms, Regimes, and Theories of the Firm Foundations

Authors: Sergei Mozheiko, Xianwei Shi, Tony W. Tong

DOI: [10.5465/annals.2025.0078](https://doi.org/10.5465/annals.2025.0078)

Published: 2026-07-28

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Entrepreneurship
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Transaction Cost Economics, Knowledge-Based View, Property Rights Theory

Abstract:

Value creation is increasingly shifting from standalone firms in linear value chains toward multilaterally coordinated efforts among heterogeneous actors in ecosystems. Yet, we know relatively little about how coordination unfolds when value creation activities are distributed in this manner. As a focal entity grows increasingly reliant on actors beyond its formal authority, value creation and capture depend on aligning and steering these interdependent actors through indirect means—an approach best described as “orchestration.” We define “ecosystem orchestration” as the application of control and coordination mechanisms beyond organizational boundaries to integrate complementary efforts across ecosystem participants. First, through a comprehensive integrative review, we identify four categories of mechanisms: codified, cognitive, incentive, and hierarchical. We then examine how these mechanisms are bundled into distinct orchestration regimes across platform, industrial, innovation, and entrepreneurial ecosystems. Further, we highlight salient connections between these mechanisms and classic theories of the firm—resource-based view, property rights theory, transaction cost economics, and knowledge-based view. By moving beyond generic notions of orchestration and revealing its underlying mechanisms, we establish a clearer foundation for advancing ecosystem research, integrate the fragmented ecosystem orchestration literature, and anchor it more firmly in established theories. Finally, we conclude by outlining conceptual, empirical, and methodological directions for future inquiry.

□ Mozheiko - Ecosystem Orchestration Mechanisms, Regimes, and Theories of the Firm Foundation.pdf
